

popularity of railways among the masses, in May 1845, the EIC announced that it would lend its support to the well-considered proposals.

With this encouragement, the same month, the EIR's provisional committee established EIR into a joint-stock company. This energized the GIPR's provisional committee, which soon released its own prospectus. The objective was to connect the interiors of the country with Bombay on one end and with the port on the eastern coast.

Scepticism and solution

The Court of Directors, however, were still not convinced about the feasibility of railways in India. It saw the country's climate, vegetation, and unskilled population as impediments to the enterprise.

A group of engineers, including FW Simms as civil engineer and J Fraser as assistant engineer were deputed to examine the railway question. They proposed some alterations to the lines, but concluded that the problems the Court feared had practical solutions and that the railways in India could be seamlessly constructed and operated.